CITY OF INGLEWOOD

OFFICE OF MAYOR JAMES T. BUTTS, JR.

Inglewood All-America City 2009

DATE: April 28, 2026

TO: Council Members

FROM: James T. Butts, Jr., Mayor
Mark Fronterotta, Chief of Police

SUBJECT: **Mayoral Initiative: Resolution Approving Acceptance FY 2026 Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS); Grant Agreement; Approving a FY 2026 Budget Amendment for the C-UAS Grant; and Authorizing the Purchase of a Comprehensive Public Safety Technology Package**

RECOMMENDATION:
Adopt a Resolution approving acceptance of the FY 2026 Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) Grant, amending the FY 2026 Budget, approving a Public Safety Technology Package in an amount not to exceed $6,275,772; and authorizing the City Manager, or designee, to negotiate and execute an agreement with Axon Enterprise, Inc.

BACKGROUND:
The City of Inglewood has made significant progress in advancing public safety, with recent data demonstrating a continued decline in crime facilitated by strategic investments, proactive policing, and strong community partnerships. The Police Department's (Department) ongoing strategic commitment to innovation, community engagement, and operational excellence has positioned the City as a leader in modern public safety practices.

While a combination of technologies are currently in place, they operate independently of one another and with limited synergy. Adopting a unified and scalable infrastructure will enhance interoperability, improve operational effectiveness, and support long-term public safety and crime reduction efforts. ***In Inglewood, Part I Crimes fell 13% in 2025 compared to 2024, led by a 60% drop in Homicides and a 32% drop in Burglaries reported in our City. As of December 31, 2025, compared to its peak in 1981, violent crime has fallen 76% and homicides have fallen 87%.***

To sustain and build upon these historic Public Safety benchmarks, the Department proposes to continue to strengthen its technological capacity through the implementation of updated, integrated systems that will further enhance our public safety capabilities. These include automated license plate readers, a comprehensive digital evidence management platform, augmented by Unmanned Aircraft Systems, Body-Worn Cameras, and In-Car Video systems. This research has been underway since August of 2025.

CI-1.

Additionally, in January 2026, the Chief of Police directed his staff to research the availability of Federal grant funding for Body Worn-Camera Systems and Counter Unmanned Aircraft Systems. Because of these efforts, the City has been awarded a Fiscal Year 2026 Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) Grant through the California Governor's Office of Emergency Services (Cal OES). This grant supports enhanced detection, monitoring, mitigation and response capabilities related to unmanned aerial systems and reflects the City's continued commitment to strengthening public safety through strategic funding opportunities.

As the City prepares to support major international and national events, including the FIFA World Cup 2026, Super Bowl 2027, and the 2028 Summer Olympics and Paralympic Games, the demand for enhanced public safety infrastructure will increase significantly. The City is expected to experience a substantial influx of visitors associated with these events, requiring advanced and integrated systems to ensure maximum public safety, operational readiness, and effective security coordination.

This increase in activity across the region will place heightened demands on public safety resources and coordination. Continued investment in an updated, integrated infrastructure reflects the City's strategic commitment to maintaining a safe community, enhancing real-time operational capabilities, and ensuring readiness for both current and future public safety needs.

DISCUSSION:
The City has been awarded a Fiscal Year 2026 C-UAS Grant through the Cal OES. This grant will support enhanced detection, monitoring, and response capabilities related to unmanned aerial systems. Uses include radar detection, radio frequency (RF) detection, thermal imaging, command and control systems, mitigation, and mobile response capabilities to address emerging drone-related public safety risks. This grant-funded program will operate independently from the Officer Safety Technology Package and further strengthens the City's overall public safety readiness.

The proposed Officer Safety Technology Package represents a strategic investment in enhancing the City's public safety infrastructure and serves as a key component of the City's broader effort to leverage technology to upgraded policing operations. This initiative builds upon the City's existing public safety efforts by integrating advanced tools that support proactive, data-driven policing and improved service delivery.

Key components include a real-time crime center integration that will support coordinated, data-driven decision-making throughout the Department, automated license plate readers to assist with proactive identification of vehicles associated with criminal activity, a centralized digital evidence enhancement system that will streamline evidence storage, sharing, and case management, body-worn cameras with enhanced video capture capabilities to support accountability and evidence collection; in-car video systems to document critical incidents from multiple perspectives, and drone technology to provide real-time aerial situational awareness during critical incidents and large-scale events.

Axon Enterprise, Inc. (Axon) is uniquely positioned to provide a fully integrated public safety technology ecosystem that allows the City to implement a comprehensive solution within a single platform. While other vendors may offer individual components, Axon delivers these systems in a unified environment that enhances system compatibility, reduces administrative burden, and improves operational efficiency. In addition, Axon provides comprehensive training, ongoing technical support, and dedicated resources to ensure successful implementation and long-term system effectiveness.

The proposed purchase is exempt from the City's competitive bidding requirements, pursuant to *Inglewood Municipal Code section 2-198.1(a)(5) (Cooperative Purchasing),* which authorizes the City to utilize contracts competitively solicited by other public agencies. The equipment and services are anticipated to be procured through the OMNIA Partners cooperative purchasing program, based on Contract No. 3544-21-4615 between Axon Enterprise, Inc. and the University of Nebraska. Staff will ensure the final agreement is consistent with the pricing and terms available under that cooperative contract.

The specific agreement with Axon Enterprise, Inc. is currently under development. Staff is seeking City Council authorization to proceed with final negotiations and to execute the agreement upon completion, consistent with the scope, pricing structure, and cooperative purchasing terms described herein, and subject to City Attorney review and approval as to form.

FINANCIAL/FUNDING ISSUES AND SOURCES:
The Fiscal Year 2026 C-UAS Grant Agreement, in the amount of $2,782,208, will support a separate public safety initiative and is not being used to fund the proposed Officer Safety Technology Package. The City will have to front the expenditure and then be reimbursed upon proof of implementation. New account codes will be established within the Public Safety Grants Fund to receive and expend grant funds (Exhibit A).

The Mayor has negotiated a total estimated cost for Inglewood of the proposed Public Safety Technology Package of $6,275,772, (a 27% discount from their normal and customary pricing) distributed over a five-year period (average of $1,255,154 per year; however, the City has the option to backload the payment schedule), in accordance with the pricing structure outlined in the attached summary of the vendor quote (Attachment 3). The estimated equipment deployment cost includes equipment, software, licensing, cloud storage, maintenance, training, and ongoing 24/7 support services (Attachment 4). The equipment package is currently supported by the General Fund.

The cost structure reflects a phased, multi-year implementation model. The first year includes initial deployment and training costs, while the second year reflects steady-state operations with slightly lower costs. In subsequent years, costs increase as the program reaches full operational capacity, including equipment refresh, software licensing, increased data storage, and ongoing maintenance and support. This approach allows the City to distribute costs over time, while ensuring long-term system reliability and performance.

The cost structure reflects a phased, multi-year implementation model. The first year includes initial deployment and training costs, while the second year reflects steady-state operations with slightly lower costs. In subsequent years, costs increase as the program reaches full operational capacity, including equipment refresh, software licensing, increased data storage, and ongoing maintenance and support. This approach allows the City to distribute costs over time, while ensuring long-term system reliability and performance.

Staff will continue to pursue additional funding opportunities to further reduce the financial impact on the General Fund. Ongoing operational costs will be incorporated into future budget planning.

ATTACHMENTS:

1. Resolution
   Exhibit A – C-UAS Budget Amendment
2. Cal OES Notification of Grant Award for C-UAS
3. Axon Enterprise, Inc. Estimated Cost Summary
4. Axon Enterprise, Inc. Equipment Deployment Cost Summary

PREPARED BY:
James T. Butts, Jr - Mayor
Aleathia Scott - Grants Manager

COUNCIL PRESENTERS:
Mark Fronterotta - Chief of Police

APPROVAL VERIFICATION SHEET

DEPARTMENT HEAD APPROVAL: _____
Mark Fronterotta, Chief of Police

MAYORAL APPROVAL: _____
James T. Butts Jr., Mayor

ATTACHMENT 1

RESOLUTION NO.: _____

A RESOLUTION OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF INGLEWOOD, CALIFORNIA, APPROVING ACCEPTANCE OF THE FY 2026 COUNTER-UNMANNED AIRCRAFT SYSTEMS (C-UAS) GRANT, AMENDING THE FY 2025-2026 BUDGET, AND AUTHORIZING NEGOTIATION AND EXECUTION OF AN AGREEMENT WITH AXON ENTERPRISE, INC. FOR A PUBLIC SAFETY TECHNOLOGY PACKAGE

WHEREAS, the City of Inglewood Police Department seeks to enhance public safety operations through the implementation of integrated technology systems, including digital evidence management, body-worn cameras, in-car video, automated license plate readers, and related tools; and

WHEREAS, the City has been awarded a Fiscal Year 2026 Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) Grant from the California Governor's Office of Emergency Services in the amount of $2,782,208, for the period of May 1, 2026 through June 30, 2028; and

WHEREAS, the C-UAS Grant will support the acquisition and implementation of systems designed to detect, monitor, and respond to unmanned aircraft system activity; and

WHEREAS, the City Council desires to amend the FY 2026 Budget to establish the necessary accounts for receipt and expenditure of grant funds, as set forth in Exhibit A; and

WHEREAS, the City has identified a need for a comprehensive Public Safety Technology Package to support enhanced operational capabilities and coordinated public safety response; and

WHEREAS, the total cost of the Public Safety Technology Package is estimated not to exceed $6,275,772 over a five-year period; and

WHEREAS, the City intends to procure the Public Safety Technology Package through a cooperative purchasing agreement in accordance with applicable provisions of the Inglewood Municipal Code; and

WHEREAS, the City Council desires to authorize the City Manager, or designee, to negotiate and execute an agreement for such services, subject to approval as to form by the City Attorney.

NOW THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Inglewood, California, does hereby:

SECTION 1. Accepts the FY 2026 Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) Grant from the California Governor's Office of Emergency Services in the amount of $2,782,208.

SECTION 2. Amend the City's 2025-2026 budget to reflect the adjustments as shown in Exhibit "A."

SECTION 3. Approves a Public Safety Technology Package for the Police Department in an amount not to exceed $6,275,772.

SECTION 4. The City Manager, or designee, is hereby authorized to negotiate and execute an agreement with Axon Enterprise, Inc., and any related documents, consistent with the scope described herein and subject to approval as to form by the City Attorney.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Clerk shall certify to the adoption of this Resolution and the same shall be in full force and effect immediately upon adoption.

Passed, approved and adopted this _____ day of _____, 2026.

CITY OF INGLEWOOD

_____
James T. Butts, Jr.,
Mayor

ATTEST:

_____
Aisha L. Thompson,
City Clerk

EXHIBIT A

FY 2026 Budget Amendment

Fund: 226 Public Safety Grants
Agency: 045 Police Department
Orgn: 4513 Support Services - Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) / Cal OES

Revenue Code		FY2025-26 Budget	Amended Budget	Increase/ Decrease
5XXX.XX	C-UAS Revenues	0.00	2,782,208.00	2,782,208.00
	Total	0.00	2,782,208.00	2,782,208.00

Fund: 226 Public Safety Grants
Agency: 045 Police Department
Orgn: 4513 Support Services - Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) / Cal OES

Expenditure Code		FY2025-26 Budget	Amended Budget	Increase/ Decrease
67000	Machinery & Equipment	0.00	2,661,455.00	2,661,455.00
44400	Training	0.00	82,988.00	82,988.00
11100	Personnel Regular OT - Exercise	0.00	37,765.00	37,765.00
	Total	0.00	2,782,208.00	2,782,208.00

ATTACHMENT 2

GAVIN NEWSOM
GOVERNOR

CHRISTINA CURRY
ACTING DIRECTOR

Cal OES
GOVERNOR'S OFFICE OF EMERGENCY SERVICES

February 6, 2026

DELIVERED VIA E-MAIL: LThreat@cityofinglewood.org

L'Oreal Threat
City of Inglewood Police Department
One West Manchester Blvd.
Inglewood, CA 90301-1764

SUBJECT: **NOTIFICATION OF SUBRECIPIENT ALLOCATION**
Fiscal Year (FY) 2026 Counter-Unmanned Aircraft Systems (C-UAS) Grant Program
Subaward Performance Period: July 4, 2025, to June 30, 2028

Dear L'Oreal Threat:

We are pleased to announce your FY 2026 C-UAS Grant Program subaward in the amount of $2,782,208. A detailed breakdown of each funded project and the corresponding award amounts is attached.

This subaward is subject to requirements in Title 2 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 200, including the Notice of Funding Opportunity (NOFO), the Preparedness Grants Manual, the California Supplement to the NOFO, reporting requirements, and all applicable federal, state, and local requirements. All activities funded with this subaward must be completed within the subaward performance period.

Subrecipients must obtain additional approval **prior** to incurring costs for activities such as aviation, watercraft, allowability request logs, noncompetitive procurement, and projects requiring Environmental Planning and Historic Preservation review.

As a condition of this award, no grant funds for mitigation costs may be released, drawn down, or reimbursed for a subrecipient until FEMA receives and approves written verification that the recipient has met the training requirement established in the NOFO. Funds will be placed on hold for the subrecipient and any mitigation-related costs until this verification is complete. Once the required grant documents are received and approved, you may request reimbursement of eligible grant expenditures using the Cal OES Financial Management Forms Workbook.

Your dated signature is required on this letter. Please sign and return this letter to your Cal OES Grants Analyst (GA) within 20 calendar days upon receipt and keep a copy for your records. For further assistance, please contact your Cal OES GA.

Sincerely,

Christina Curry
Acting Director

Enclosure:
FY 2026 C-UAS Grant Program Projects

Please sign below and submit to your Grants Analyst:

~~L'Oreal Threat~~ MARK FRONTEROTTA
City of Inglewood Police Department Chief of Police

12/10/24
Date

FY 2026 CUAS Grant Program Projects
Inglewood Police Department

Project Name	POETE Category	Funding Amount*
All Proposed Equipment Projects	Equipment	$2,661,455
All Proposed Training Projects	Training	$82,988
All Proposed Exercise Projects	Exercises	$37,765
TOTAL		**$2,782,208**

***Up to 3% of each project's funding amount may be used for grant management and administrative purposes.**

ATTACHMENT 3

ATTACHMENT 3

Axon Enterprise, Inc. Total Estimated Cost Summary (5-Year Term)

Fiscal Year	Payment Date	Annual Subtotal	Tax	Total Annual Payment
FY 2025–26	Sep-26	$925,371.51	$33,624.08	$958,995.59
FY 2026–27	Sep-27	$879,610.39	$28,154.51	$907,764.90
FY 2027–28	Sep-28	$1,424,088.25	$45,582.14	$1,469,670.39
FY 2028–29	Sep-29	$1,424,088.25	$45,582.14	$1,469,670.39
FY 2029–30	Sep-30	$1,424,088.25	$45,582.08	$1,469,670.33
		$6,077,246.65	**$198,524.95**	**$6,275,771.60**

Category	Amount
Total Subtotal (Pre-Tax)	$6,077,246.65
Total Tax	$198,524.95
Total Contract Amount	**$6,275,771.60**

ATTACHMENT 4

ATTACHMENT 4

Axon Enterprise, Inc. Total Estimated Equipment Deployment Cost Summary (5-Year Term)

Equipment / System	Quantity	5-Year Estimated Cost
Fixed CCTV / AI Camera Integration (Fusus Platform)	350 camera streams	$682,500
In-Car Camera Systems (Fleet 3 Advanced)	25 vehicles	$353,430
ALPR Systems (Lightpost & Outpost)	20 lightpost / 78 outpost	$802,932
Body-Worn Cameras & TASER 10 Program	200 devices	$3,996,660
Drone Program (Skydio X10 / R10)	7 drones + 3 dock systems	$71,584
Platform, Software, Licensing & Implementation Services	Department-wide	$170,141
Evidence Management, Storage & Software	Department-wide	Included
Training, Installation & Support Services	Department-wide	
Total Estimated Equipment Deployment Cost		**$6,077,247**
Estimated Tax		$198,525
TOTAL ESTIMATED COST		**$6,275,772**